

AI Tools and Best Practices for Researchers

Preliminary set up for Session 2 (July 21, 2026)

1. Request a Biowulf account

Overview and link to request form: <https://hpc.nih.gov/docs/accounts.html>

An account requires PI permission, and there is a monthly fee per user. You will be given access to a personal data directory where you can perform analysis on Biowulf.

If you already have a Biowulf account but have not used it for 60 days, it may be locked. Please unlock it through your user dashboard: <https://hpcnihapps.cit.nih.gov/auth/dashboard/>.

2. Review the Biowulf tutorials

Link to Biowulf tutorials: https://hpc.nih.gov/training/intro_biowulf/

We also recommend taking the Linux/Bash quiz and reviewing the linked trainings as needed. This session will have minimal usage, but it is helpful for navigating Biowulf.

3. Mount your Biowulf data directory to your local machine

This will allow you to view files stored on Biowulf (e.g., html reports and pdfs) and transfer small files to your local machine.

Instructions: <https://hpc.nih.gov/docs/hpcdrive.html> (Mapped Network Drive)

For Windows machines, instead of steps 1-2:

- a. Open Windows Explorer
- b. Scroll down in the sidebar until you see "This PC" with directories (e.g., C:) listed underneath
- c. Right click "This PC" and select "Map network drive"
- d. Continue with the instructions

4. git/GitHub overview

We also recommend basic familiarity with git and GitHub, as we will be performing commands during the session: <https://docs.github.com/en/get-started/using-git/about-git>

5. Access Biowulf login node (Windows only)

To connect to remote GitHub repos on Biowulf, you will need to use the Biowulf login node. Please follow these instructions to ensure you can access it ahead of time:
<https://hpc.nih.gov/docs/ssh.html> ("Connecting from Windows"). If the instructions using OpenSSH/PowerShell are not successful, you may need to download PuTTY.